Manfred Kinder, participated in several races with me, but I won each of them.

We spent about fifteen or twenty days in Germany, and one amusing incident still stands out. On the day we arrived in Cologne, one of our team members, Lal Chand, champion of the 26-mile marathon, was the cause of much hilarity. The team was staying in a high-rise hotel and had been allocated rooms on different floors. When we reached the hotel, we were told to deposit our luggage in our respective rooms and then assemble in the dining room on the ground floor. Being familiar with the mechanics of how a lift worked, we reached our destination without any mishap. But not Lal Chand, a simple-minded fellow ignorant of new technology, who went up and down for thirty minutes, without knowing how to get off. Each time he tried to step out of the lift the doors would close on him. When the other passengers enquired which floor he wanted, he did not understand what they were saying, and just smiled. Finally, he landed on the ground floor, wearing no necktie or shoes, just his bathroom slippers. He looked dishevelled and harassed and complained loudly that he been caught in the clutches of a demonic contraption that refused to let him go! We were embarrassed by his appearance and the attention he was attracting from the other diners and immediately dispatched him to his room, telling him that he must return properly dressed for dinner. But he lost his bearings, again. After dinner I went to Lal Chand's room to find out what had happened and found him arguing with the hotel staff. Apparently, his shoes and suitcase were missing from his room. I tried to reason with him, explaining that this was a five-star hotel with a reputation to uphold, and that his baggage could not have been stolen; it must have been misplaced and would be returned to him. But my words had no effect on him and he marched out of the room.

His next target was the receptionist, who could not understand what he was saying, but was eager to help a guest. She sent a couple of attendants up to his room, and when they entered, he pointed towards his bare feet to indicate that he had could not find his shoes. Misunderstanding him, they took him to a shoe shop where he raised a ruckus again, saying that he didn't want new shoes, he wanted his own ones back. When he returned to his room, he explained the situation to me in Punjabi and I communicated the problem of his missing clothes to the interpreter in English. It was then that we discovered that he had left his room in such a mess that the staff had helpfully tidied up after him—his shoes had been placed under the